developing a desktop app. That often resulted in apps that were slow, with lots of interdependencies, and that were hard to maintain.

Web Forms provided a page-based programming model, which is why Razor Pages sometimes gets associated with them. However, as you've seen, Razor Pages is based on the MVC design pattern, and it exposes the intrinsic features of the web without trying to hide them from you.

Razor Pages optimizes certain flows using conventions, but it's not trying to build a *stateful* application model over the top of a stateless web application, in the way that Web Forms did.

If you were a fan of Web Forms' stateful application model, you should consider Blazor Server, which uses a similar paradigm but embraces the web instead of fighting against it. You can read more about the similarities at http://mng.bz/7Dy9.

In MVC, a single controller can have multiple action methods. Each action handles a different request and generates a different response. The grouping of multiple actions in a controller is somewhat arbitrary, but it's typically used to group actions related to a specific entity or resource: to-do list items in this case. A more complete version of the `ToDoController` in listing 19.4 might include action methods for listing all to-do items, for creating new items, and for deleting items, for example. Unfortunately, you can often find that your controllers become large and bloated, with many dependencies.[1]

NOTE You don't have to make your controllers very large like this. It's just a common pattern. You could, for example, create a separate controller for every action instead.

Another pitfall of MVC controllers is the way they're typically organized in your project. Most action methods in a controller need an associated Razor view, for generating the HTML, and a view model for passing data to the view. The MVC approach in .NET traditionally groups classes by type (controller, view, view model), while the Razor Page approach groups by function; everything related to a specific page is co-located.